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TU**

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an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Lifelong Learning at SETU Design Toolkit

Version 1 / July 2026

Lifelong Learning at SETU extends the strength and credibility of the SETU brand to learners at every stage of life. Designed for adult learners, professionals and organisations, it supports flexible pathways to upskilling, reskilling, career progression and personal growth.

While remaining closely aligned to the SETU masterbrand, Lifelong Learning serves audiences with different needs, motivations and learning journeys. This tailored toolkit provides guidance on messaging, imagery and communication approaches that create a more supportive, accessible and relevant experience while maintaining the quality, trust and reputation of SETU.

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How We Speak

Who We Speak to

Different audiences have different motivations, barriers and aspirations. The messaging examples below show how the core Lifelong Learning at SETU proposition can be adapted to resonate with each audience while maintaining a clear and consistent brand position.



Adult Learners Returning to Education

Returning to study can feel like learning to ride a bike all over again. Lifelong Learning at SETU's programmes offer the reassurance of university-quality teaching, recognised qualifications and supportive learning pathways, all grounded in the academic standards and credibility of SETU.



First-Time Higher Education Learners

Entering higher education for the first time can be a nervous step into the unknown. Will you feel out of your depth? Will it all be worth it? Lifelong Learning at SETU provides an accessible and encouraging introduction to university study, backed by the recognised academic standards and reputation of SETU.



Career Changers

Changing career direction requires confidence and trusted guidance. Through Lifelong Learning at SETU's programmes, learners can combine flexible study with the strength of a respected university, building new expertise through programmes rooted in SETU's academic credentials and industry relevance.

Who We Speak to (continued)

Different audiences have different motivations, barriers and aspirations. The messaging examples below show how the core Lifelong Learning at SETU proposition can be adapted to resonate with each audience while maintaining a clear and consistent brand position.



Mid-Career Professionals

Professionals seeking to deepen expertise or progress within their field benefit from Lifelong Learning at SETU that reflects the University’s academic rigour and professional credibility, delivered in formats designed to complement demanding careers.



Employers and Organisations

Lifelong Learning at SETU’s programmes enable organisations to invest in workforce capability through accredited, university-backed learning that upholds the same standards of excellence, innovation and applied knowledge associated with SETU.



Learners Seeking Flexible Upskilling

Flexible study doesn’t mean compromised learning. Through online, blended and part-time delivery, Lifelong Learning at SETU’s programmes provide academically robust learning connected directly to the wider university experience and standards of SETU.

Who We Speak to (continued)

Different audiences have different motivations, barriers and aspirations. The messaging examples below show how the core Lifelong Learning at SETU proposition can be adapted to resonate with each audience while maintaining a clear and consistent brand position.



Access Programme Participants



Lifelong Learning at SETU supports wider participation in higher education by creating accessible pathways into university study, ensuring learners benefit from the same academic integrity, support and opportunities found across the University.



Learners from Disadvantaged Backgrounds

A person's background in no way reflects their ambition or ability to learn. Lifelong Learning at SETU is committed to inclusive opportunity, offering all learners with the appetite for knowledge the chance to engage with high-quality university education shaped by the University's values and academic standards.



International and Remote Learners

Why should distance limit access to academic excellence? Through Lifelong Learning at SETU, international and remote learners can access the expertise, reputation and university-standard learning experience that define the University.

Tagline and Messaging

LEARN MORE. GO FURTHER.

Whether a learner, professional, employer or organisation, this line speaks to how Lifelong Learning at SETU opens doors and creates opportunities for people, businesses and funders alike. The tagline is clear, confidence-building, encouraging and supportive, reinforcing the opportunities and progression that Lifelong Learning at SETU provides.



High Level Brand Narrative

LEARN MORE. GO FURTHER.

The idea behind Lifelong Learning at SETU is that none of us are really ever finished with education. Whether we know it or not, we're learning all the time. It's when we embrace the possibilities continuing education presents that we realise how it can transform our lives. Personally and professionally.

Designed with professionals, adult learners, career changers and organisations in mind, Lifelong Learning at SETU offers flexible pathways that fit around work, family and personal commitments, without compromising academic excellence.

We combine the university-level teaching credentials of SETU with a supportive and inclusive approach. Through online, blended and part-time learning, our programme empowers people to develop new skills, build confidence, and create meaningful growth opportunities for themselves and their employers.

This is not simply about gaining qualifications. It's about people realising what they are truly capable of, about adapting with confidence to a world that is constantly changing.

Graphic Assets



Lifelong Learning at SETU is part of the wider SETU brand ecosystem. This toolkit introduces audience-specific communication tools while maintaining alignment with the visual and strategic principles set out in the SETU Brand Guidelines.

Before using this toolkit, users should familiarise themselves with the SETU Brand Guidelines. Unless otherwise stated, all core brand assets, including logo usage, typography, colour and accessibility requirements, should follow the SETU masterbrand guidelines.

All approved assets have been supplied in both print and digital-ready formats to support consistent implementation across channels.

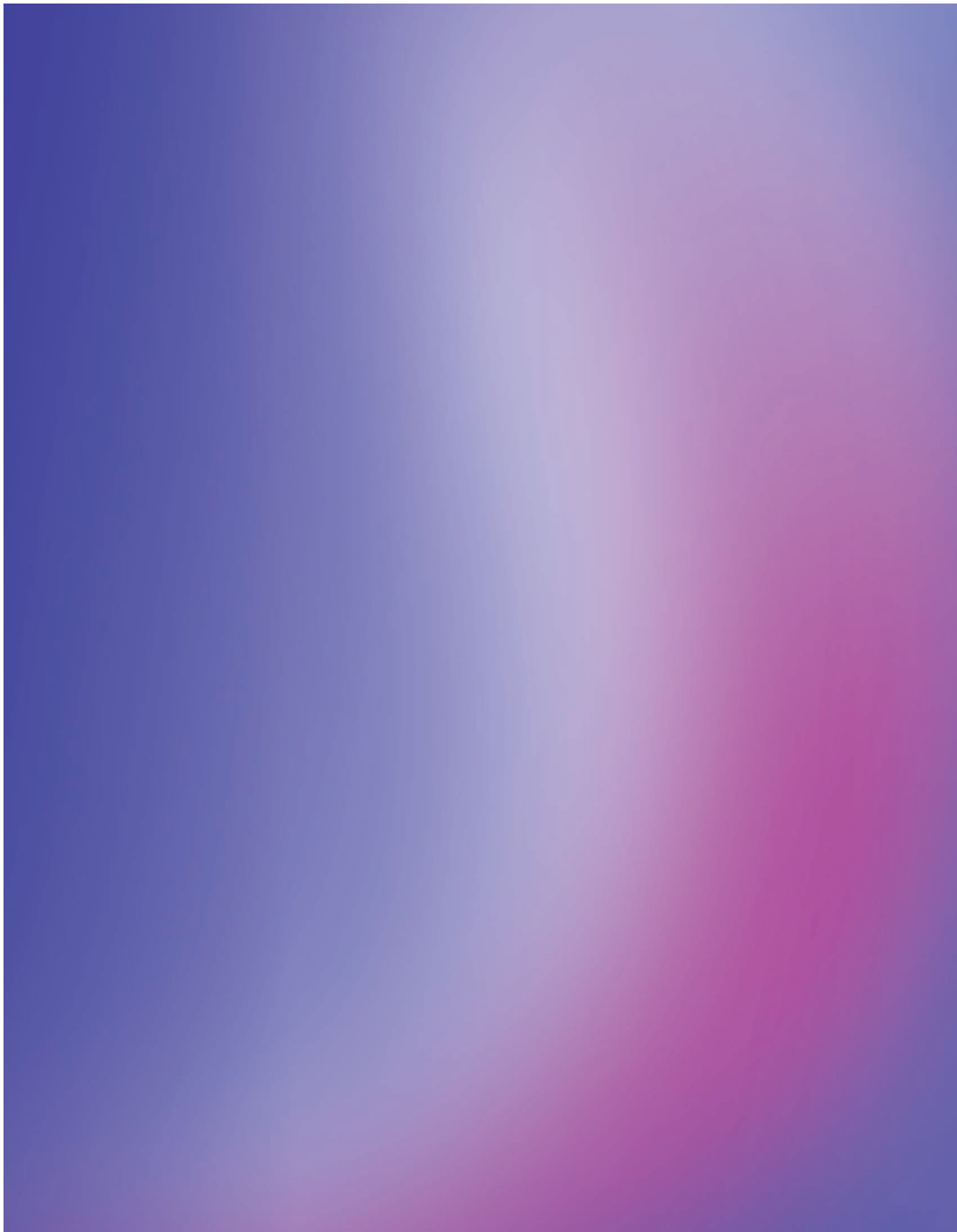
Annual Colour Strategy

The Lifelong Learning at SETU colour system is built from a selection of colours within the SETU brand palette. These colours are combined to create the programme gradients, with an approved combination refreshed each year to maintain consistency while introducing variety and visual distinction.

The 2026/27 colour palette combines Heather Purple, Sunset Red, Clover Pink, White and Slate Grey to create a distinctive visual expression for the academic year.

The 2027/28 toolkit refreshes the Lifelong Learning at SETU colour combination while retaining the same visual system. This annual evolution keeps communications feeling current while maintaining continuity and recognition.

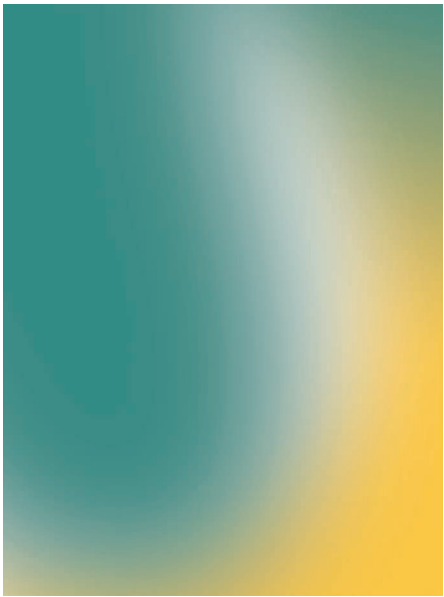
The toolkit includes gradients, crest symbol in a flat gradient and 3D treatments, U Shape assets created using the approved palette.



2026/27



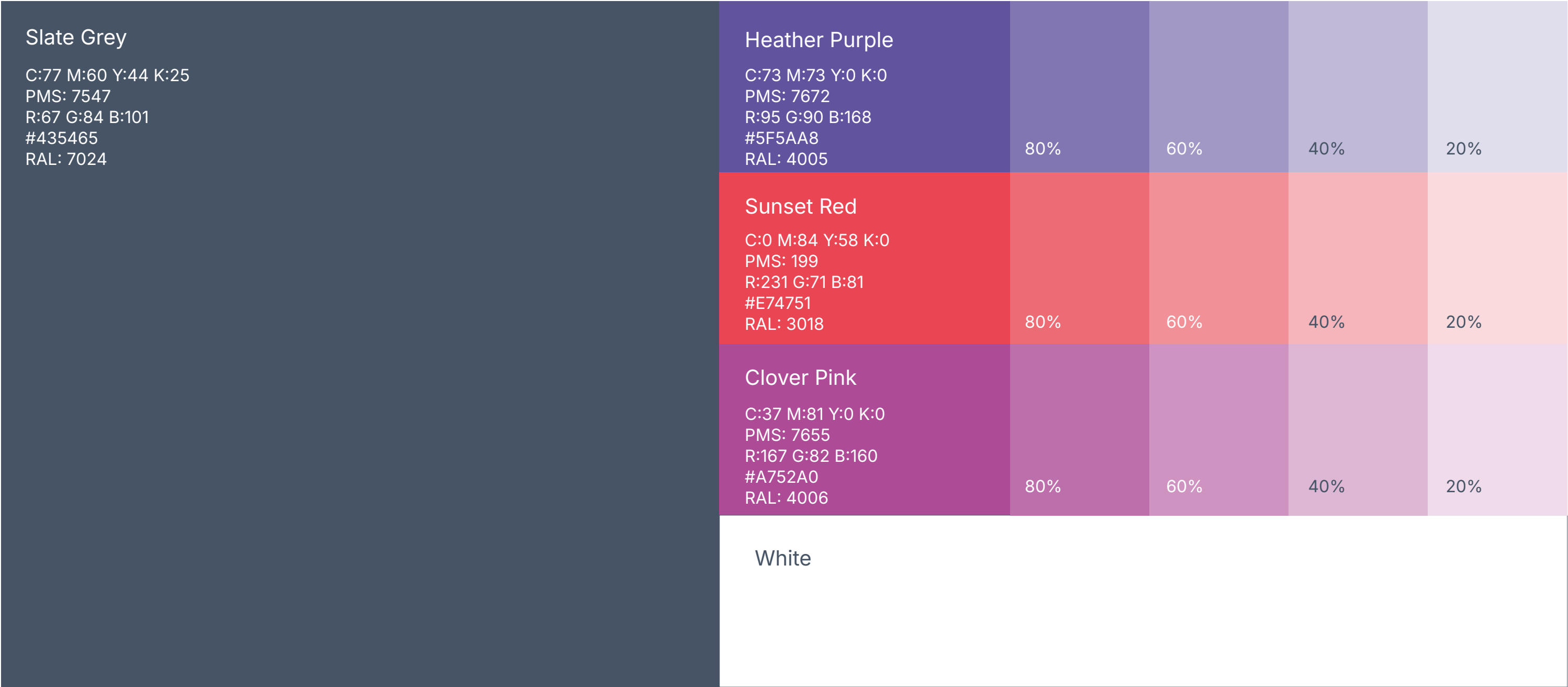
2027/28



2028/29

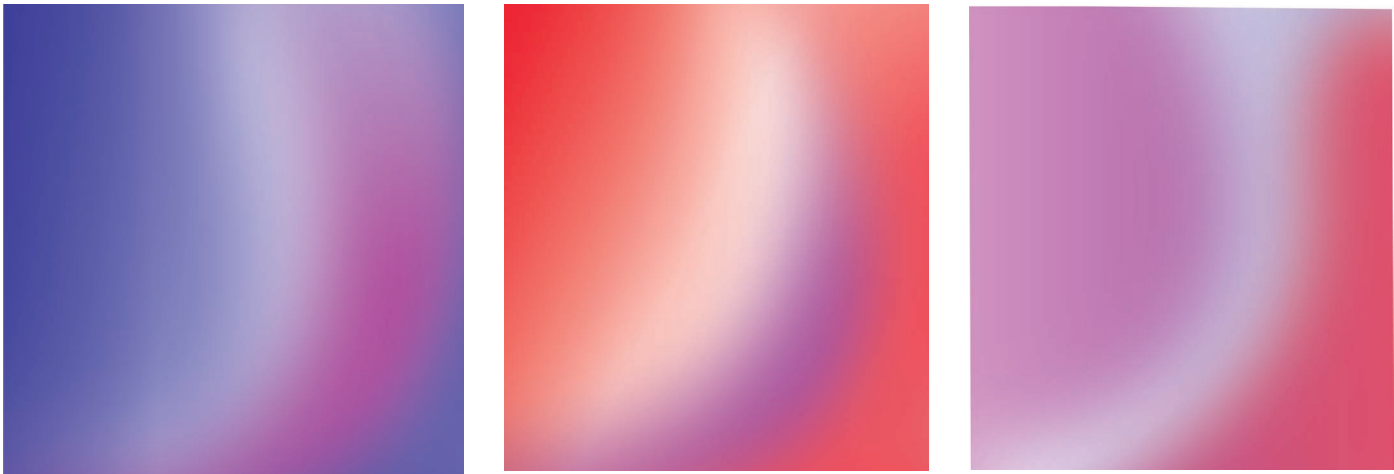
2026/27 Colour Breakdown

The Lifelong Learning at SETU colour system evolves annually. For the 2026/27 academic year, Heather Purple, Sunset Red, Clover Pink, White and Slate Grey combine to create a distinctive and energetic visual expression while maintaining a clear connection to the SETU masterbrand.

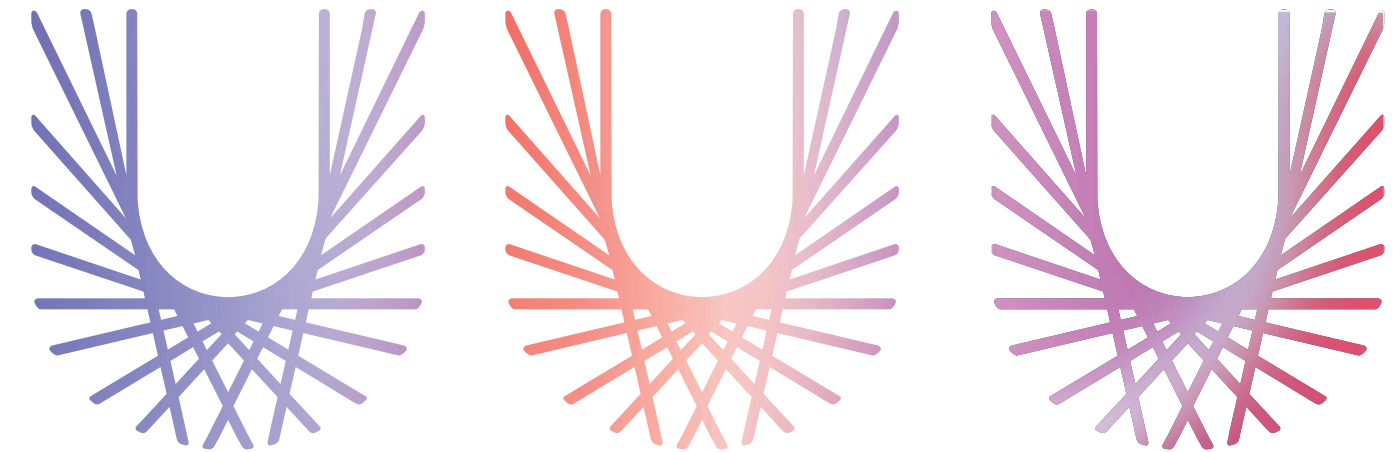


2026/27 Graphic Elements Overview

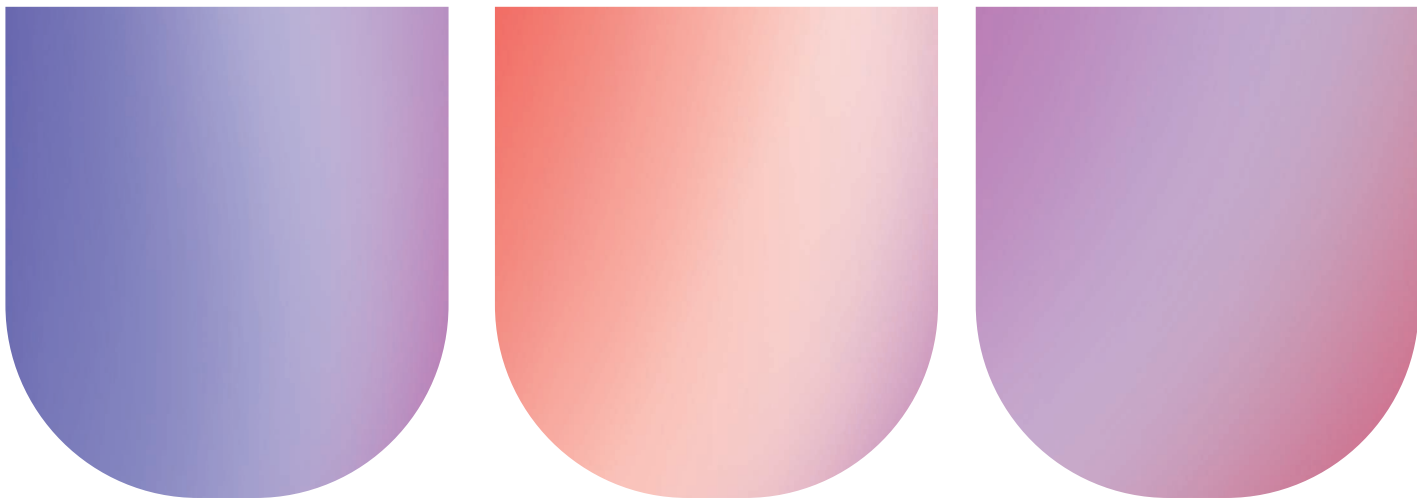
The 2026/27 toolkit combines gradients, crest symbols, U Shapes and 3D assets to create a distinctive visual language for Lifelong Learning at SETU. Together, these elements provide a flexible system that can be applied consistently across print and digital communications.



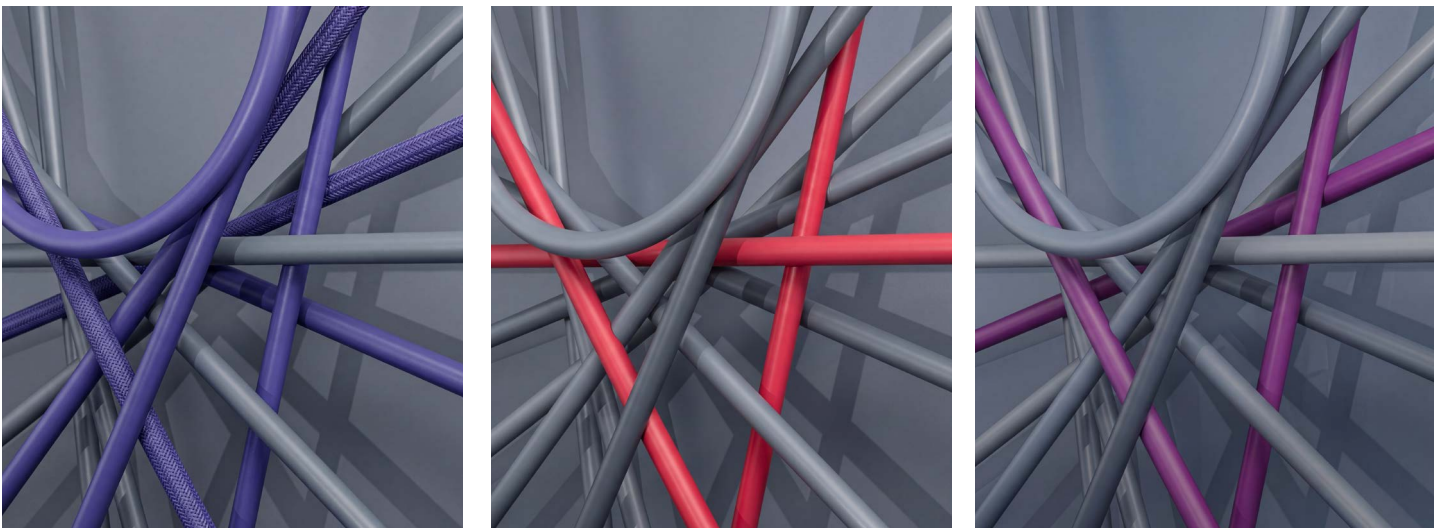
A suite of **Gradients** created using Heather Purple, Sunset Red, Clover Pink and White.



Crest Symbols using the 2026/27 gradient palette.



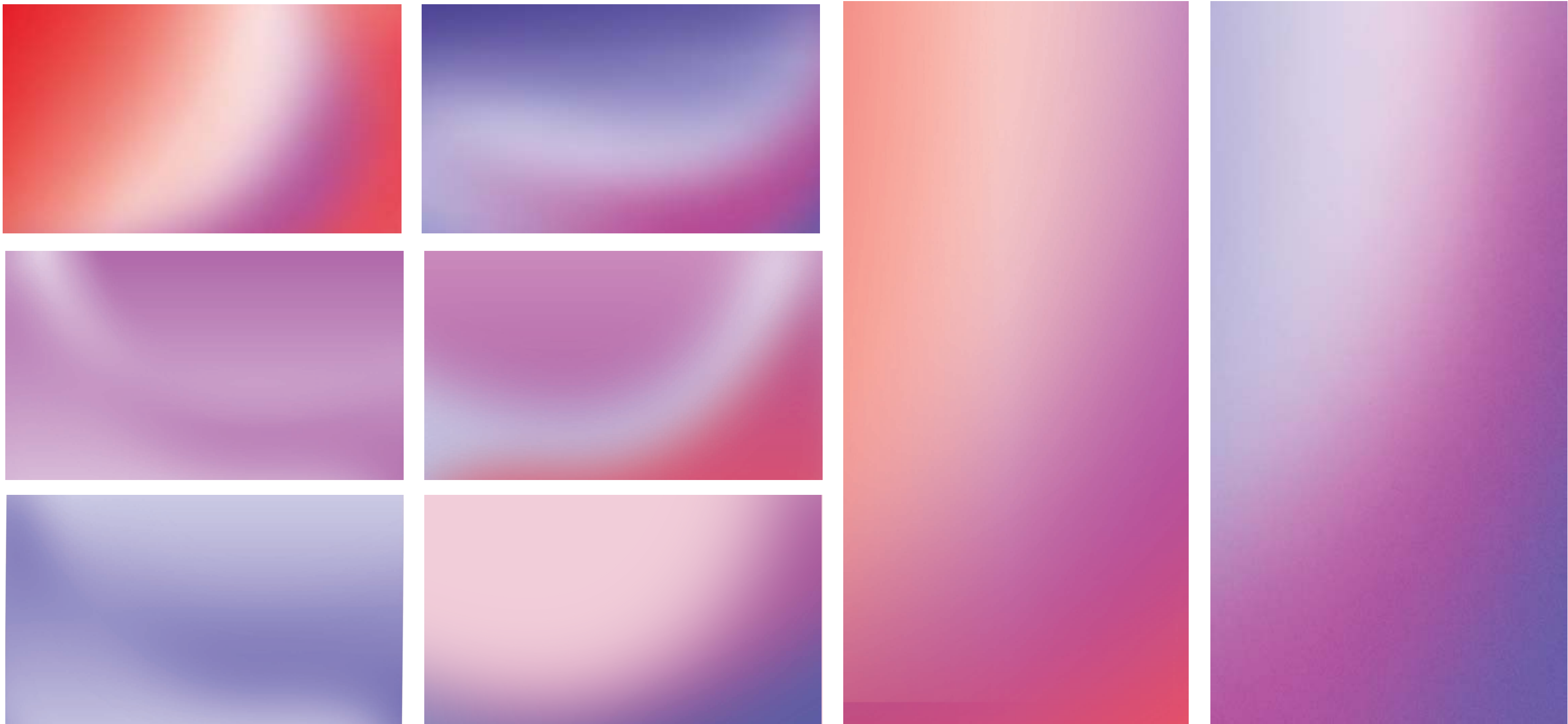
U Shapes featuring the 2026/27 gradient palette.



3D Symbols using Heather Purple, Sunset Red, Clover Pink and Slate Grey.

2026/27 Gradients

The 2026/27 gradients are built from Heather Purple, Sunset Red, Clover Pink and White. They introduce warmth, movement and energy while maintaining a clear connection to the wider SETU brand.



How to use the Gradients

Gradients are a core element of the Lifelong Learning visual identity. When applying typography over gradients, ensure sufficient contrast is maintained to support readability and accessibility across all formats.

Best Practice:

- Use Slate Grey text on lighter gradient areas.
- Use white text on darker gradient areas.
- Test contrast before final production.
- Avoid placing text across multiple tonal shifts.
- Use generous spacing around key messages.



**Make sure text
is accessible by
placing slate grey
text on light areas.**



**Make sure text
is accessible by
placing white text
on dark areas.**

How to use Gradients with U-Shapes

The U Shape is a distinctive brand device derived from the SETU identity. It can be used to house type, gradients, photography and campaign messaging, creating flexible layouts while maintaining a recognisable visual connection to the wider SETU brand.



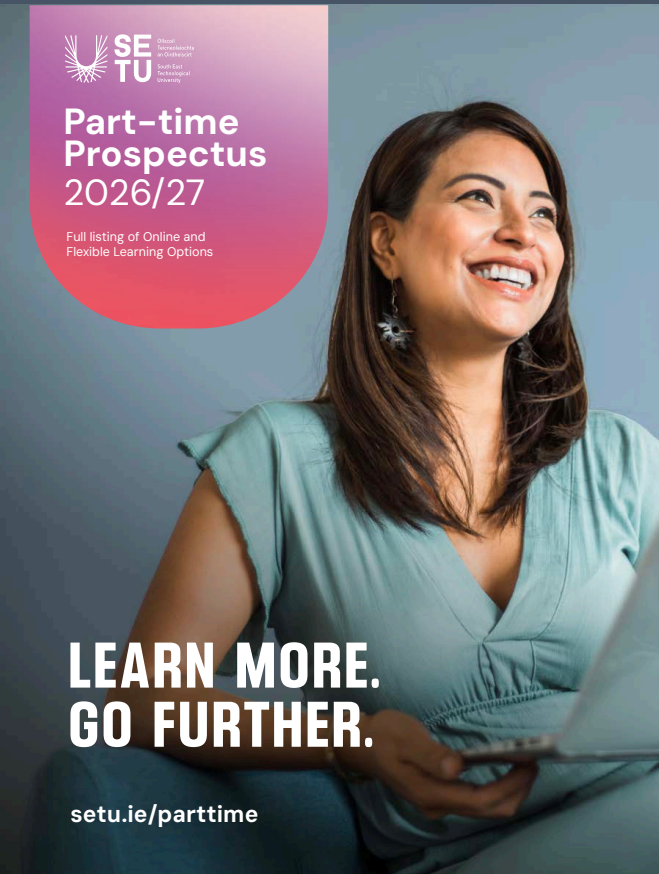
Use gradients within the U Shape.



Maintain clear margins around the shape.



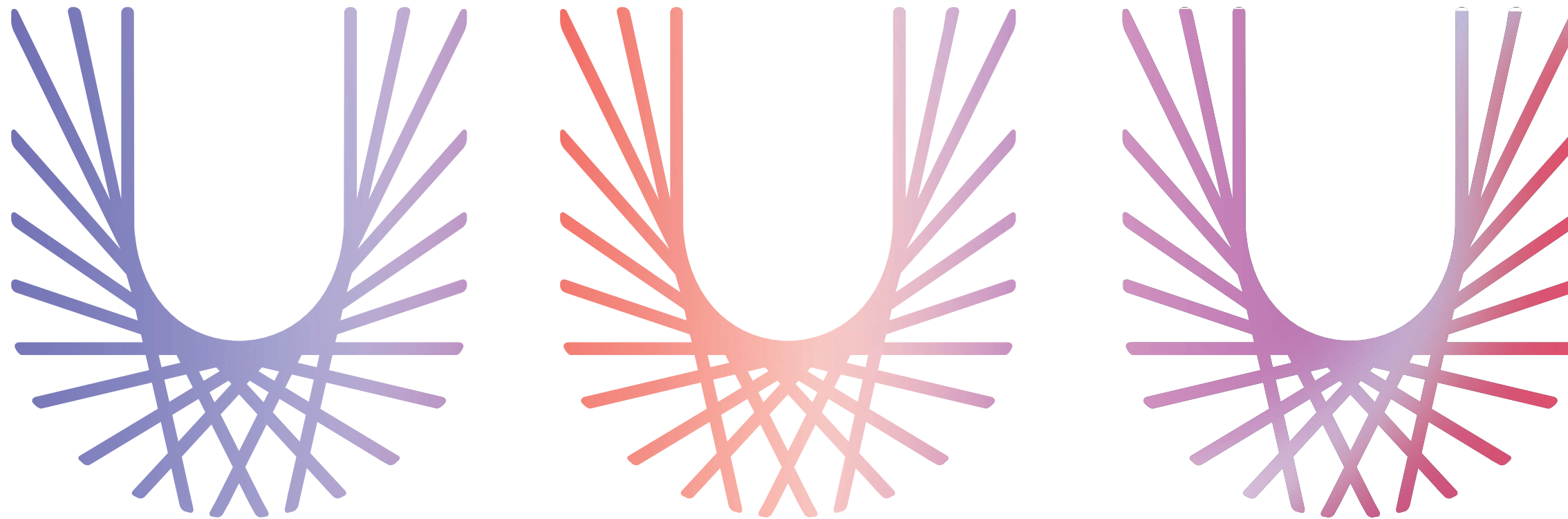
Use photography within the U Shape to highlight learners.



Ensure content remains legible within the shape.

Crest Symbols

The crest is a core asset of the SETU identity and it has been updated for Lifelong Learning at SETU communications to include gradient versions. It provides a distinctive look while remaining recognisably part of the SETU brand. Official crest assets are provided in print and digital formats and should always be used as supplied, without alteration.



How to use Crest Symbols

The crest symbol can be used to create emphasis, frame content and add visual interest across campaigns, publications and digital communications. Cropping and scaling are encouraged to create dynamic layouts while maintaining recognisability.

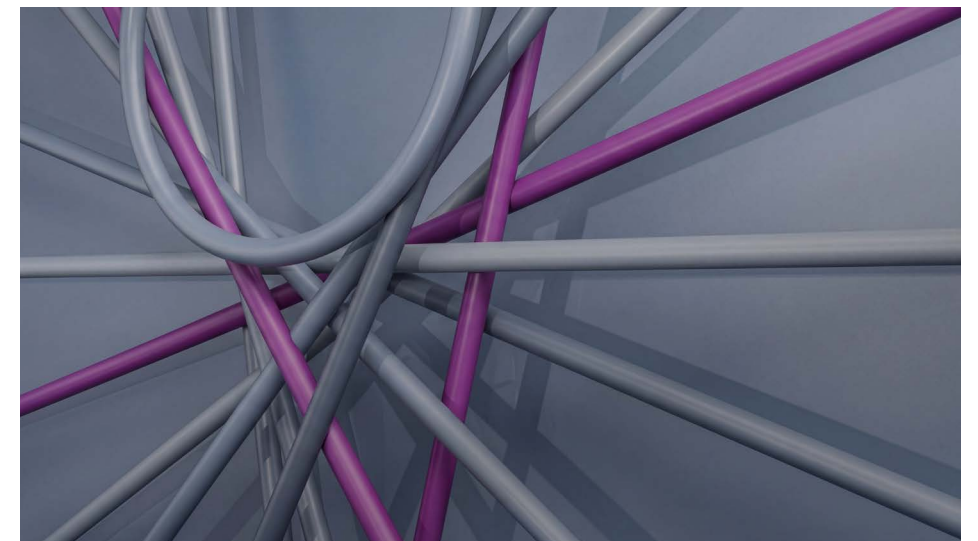
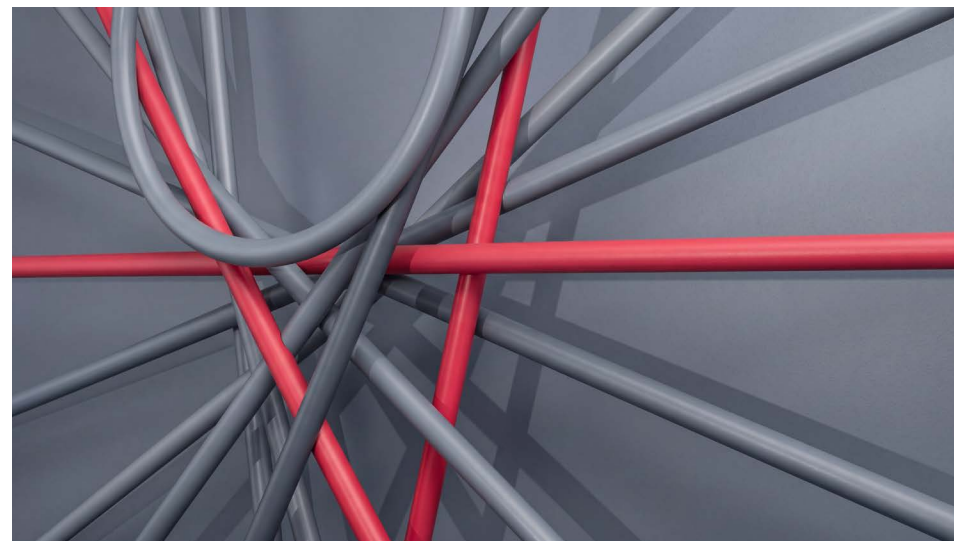
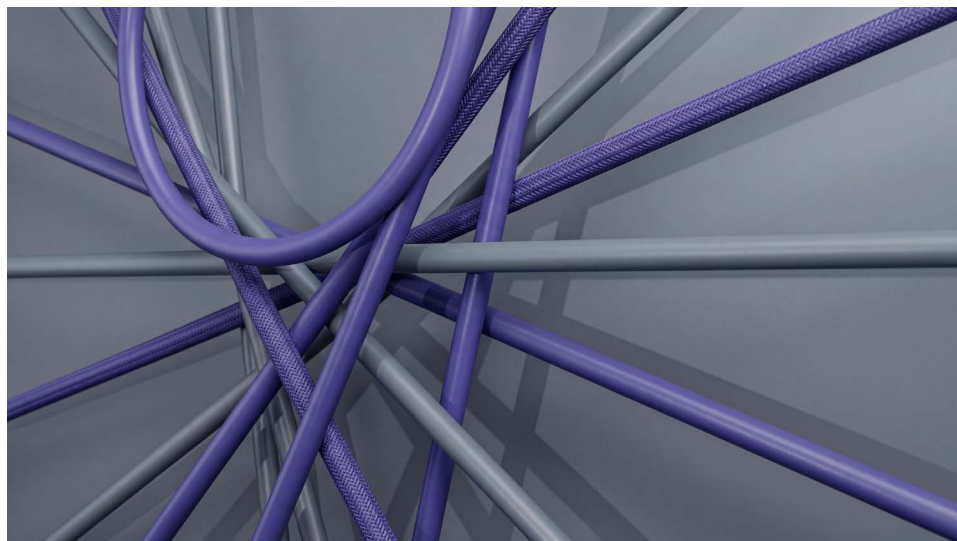
Best Practice

- Use at large scale for impact.
- Crop confidently to create dynamic compositions.
- Combine with gradients and photography.
- Ensure the symbol remains identifiable.
- Avoid repetition within a single layout.



3D Symbol

Dedicated versions of the 3D symbol have been created for the SETU Lifelong Learning programmes and offers a new angle of the existing 3D symbol in the SETU brand. The accent colour applied to each version reflects the colour palette of the relevant programme year.

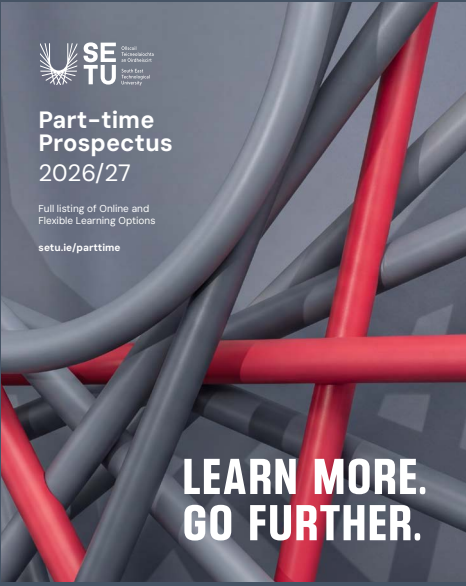


How to Use 3D Symbol

The 3D symbols work best as hero visuals, background graphics and campaign assets. Their complexity should be balanced with simple typography and generous spacing.

Best Practice:

- Use as a focal visual element.
- Crop to create abstract compositions.
- Pair with concise messaging.
- Maintain clear space around text.
- Use approved colour combinations only.

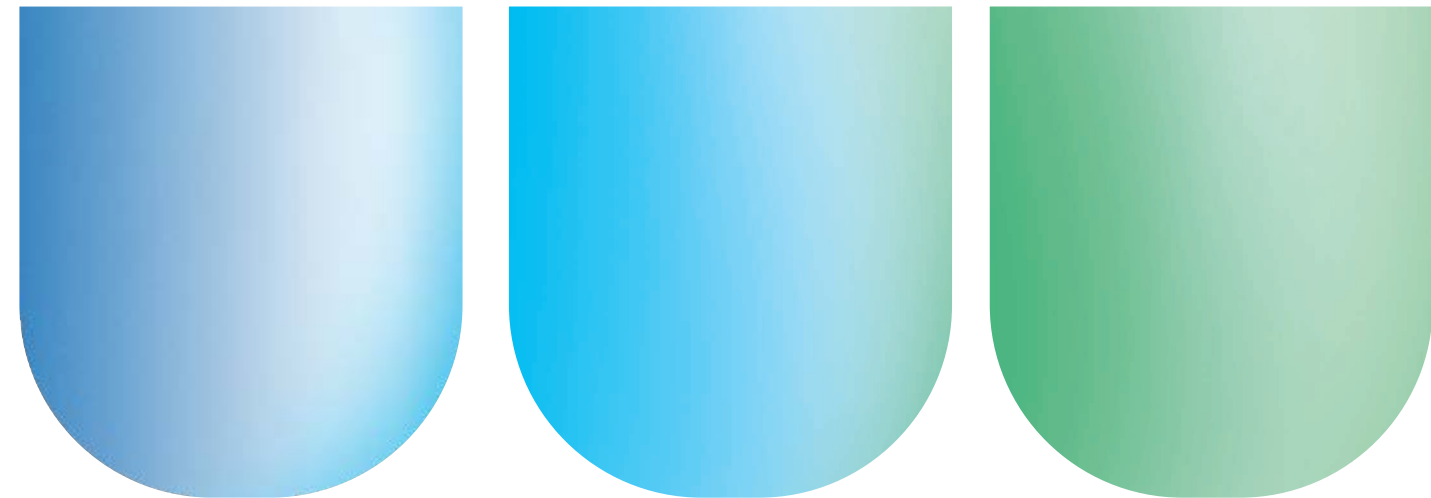


2027/28 Graphic Asset Overview

The 2027/28 toolkit evolves the visual language through a refreshed colour palette while retaining the same graphic framework. This approach creates continuity across years while giving each academic cycle its own character.



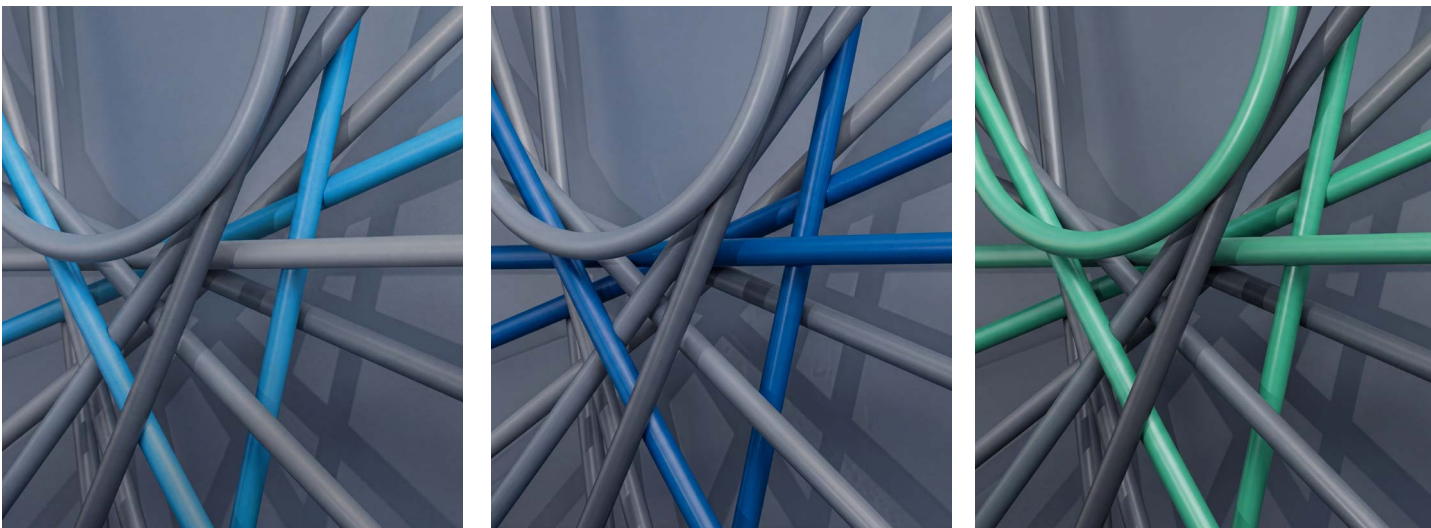
A suite of **Gradients** created using Suir Blue, Barrow Blue, Grass Green and White.



U Shapes featuring the 2027/28 gradient palette.



Crest Symbols using the 2027/28 gradient palette.



3D Symbols using Suir Blue, Barrow Blue, Grass Green and Slate Grey.

2028/29 Graphic Asset Overview

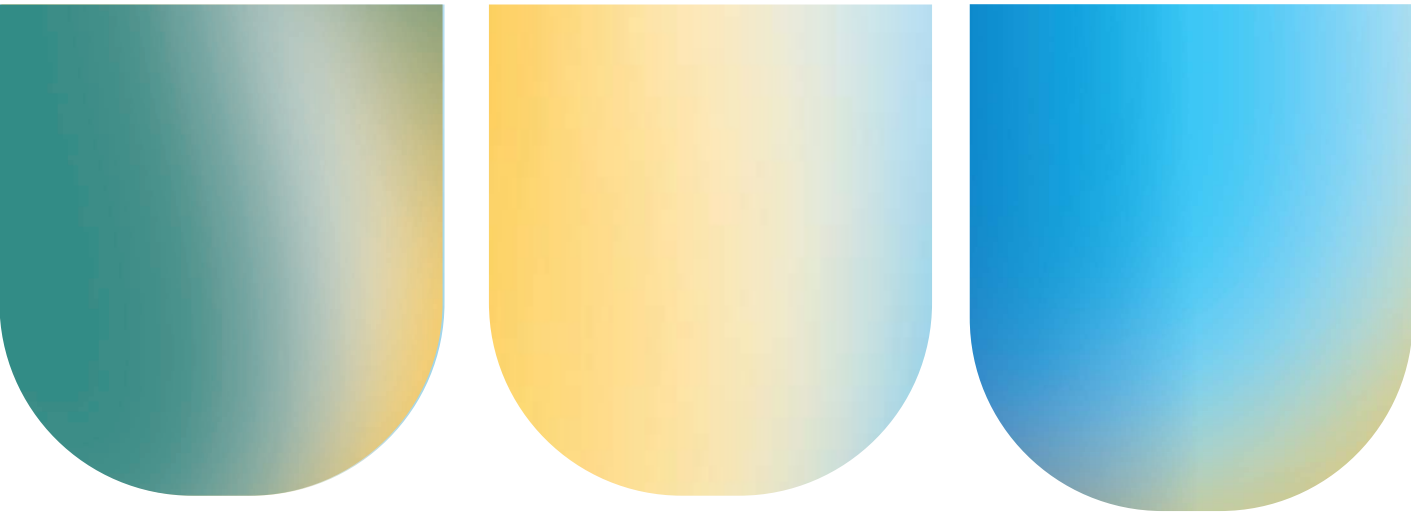
The 2028/29 toolkit introduces a new palette and graphic expression while maintaining consistency with the wider Lifelong Learning at SETU visual language. The result is a system that feels familiar, recognisable and continuously evolving.



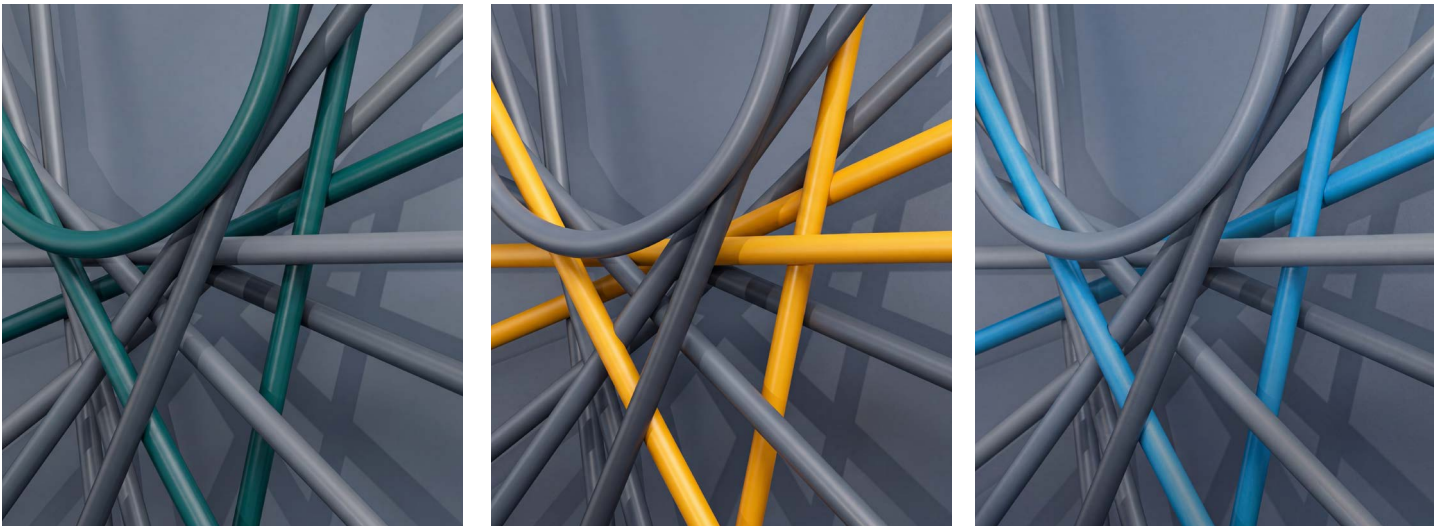
A suite of **Gradients** created using Sea Green, Sunrise Yellow, Suir Blue and White.



Crest Symbols using the 2028/29 gradient palette.



U Shapes featuring the 2028/29 gradient palette.



3D Symbols using Sea Green, Sunrise Yellow, Suir Blue and Slate Grey.

Typography

Campaign Headlines and Tagline
Compressa Condensed Black

Short Headlines
DM Sans Bold

Paragraph header and Body copy
Inter (variety of weights)

Justified type compromises accessibility
so we always try to left align our copy

CTA's
DM Sans Bold

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Part-time
Prospectus
2026/27

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setu.ie

Photography

Photography Overview

The photography themes have been adapted from the wider SETU photography framework and tailored to reflect the audiences, experiences and outcomes associated with Lifelong Learning at SETU. Together, they provides focused approach to image selection while remaining aligned with the wider SETU brand.



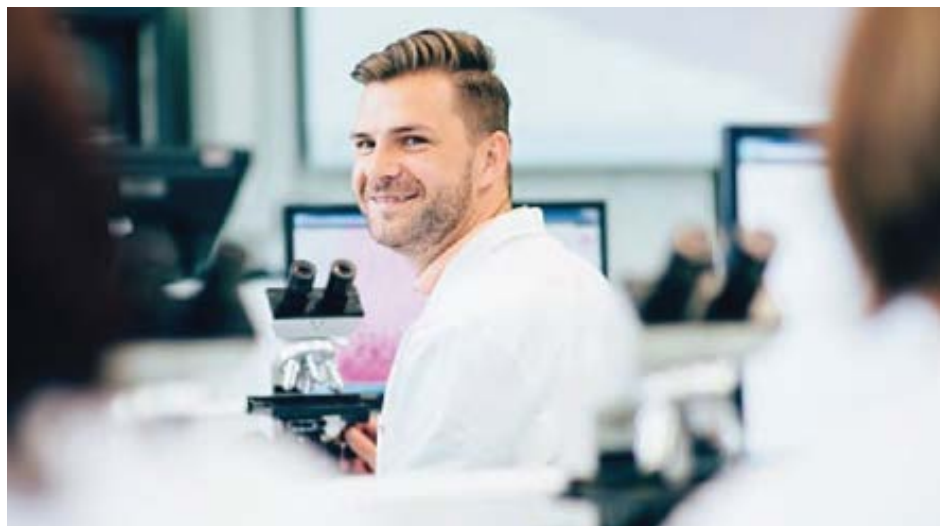
Embodied Futures



Learning in Real Life



Supported Journeys



Skills in Action



Our People

Embodied Futures

Shows learners already inhabiting the futures they are working toward, credible, aspirational and within reach.

Look for:

- Professional environments across a wide range of industries and roles.
- People actively working, leading, creating or contributing with confidence.
- Realistic career moments rather than polished corporate imagery.
- Aspirational but grounded — futures audiences can genuinely see themselves in.
- Varied settings reflecting the breadth of lifelong learning pathways and outcomes.



Learning in Real Life

Learning fitting into everyday routines rather than “student life”.

Look for:

- Homes, kitchens, shared spaces, workplaces.
- Evening or early morning study.
- Lived in environments / real & believable settings.



Supported Journeys

Learning is collaborative and supported,
not solitary and intimidating.

Look for:

- Conversations, feedback, collaboration, peer support.
- Small groups rather than large lecture halls.
- People actively doing, not passively sitting.



Skills in Action

Focuses on learning as an active process, moments of practice, application and capability building.

Look for:

- Real professional, technical or creative environments used as learning spaces.
- Applied learning moments: testing, making, experimenting, discussing, refining.
- Tools, screens, materials and work-in-progress visible within the frame.
- People developing confidence and skills rather than presenting finished expertise.
- An emphasis on participation, progression and hands-on engagement.



Our People

Natural, environmental portraits.

Aim for:

- Genuine expressions and natural interactions.
- Diverse ages, backgrounds and professions.
- Real learning environments and workplaces.
- Moments of focus, discussion, collaboration and achievement.
- Confident, optimistic and approachable subjects.

Avoid:

- Overly staged corporate photography.
- Generic stock imagery.
- Artificial poses or exaggerated expressions.
- Images that feel overly youthful or undergraduate-focused.
- Cluttered backgrounds that distract from the subject.



Photography Styling

Aim for:

- Shallow Depth of Field – soft focus elements in the foreground and background and with the subject/person of interest in focus.
- High Contrast - well exposed shots with solid blacks and highlights not over exposed.
- Soft and natural lighting.
- Strong colour saturation.
- Relaxed, natural poses.
- Avoid obvious staging.



Consider crops:

To ensure a flexible image bank consider shooting both portrait (good for mobile, some social media – Instagram) and landscape.

- Wide to capture a particular location/settingMid best for portraits.
- Close to capture materials/tools/details.
- Avoid shooting clothing/materials with obvious branding.



Brand in Action

Prospectus Covers



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Part-time
Prospectus
2026/27

Full Listing of Online and
Flexible Learning Options

LEARN MORE.
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setu.ie/parttime



SPRINGBOARD
www.springboardcourses.ie



HCI
Human
Capital
Initiative

Springboards and HCI Pillar 1
are co-funded by the
Government of Ireland
and the European Union.



Balihu na Mionann
Comhairleoir de Éireann



How is it funded?
It is co-funded by the
Government of Ireland
and the European Union.



HEA
Higher Education Authority
Aitheasc na hOllscoirí



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Prospectus
2027/28

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Part-time
Prospectus
2028/29

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Balihu na Mionann
Comhairleoir de Éireann

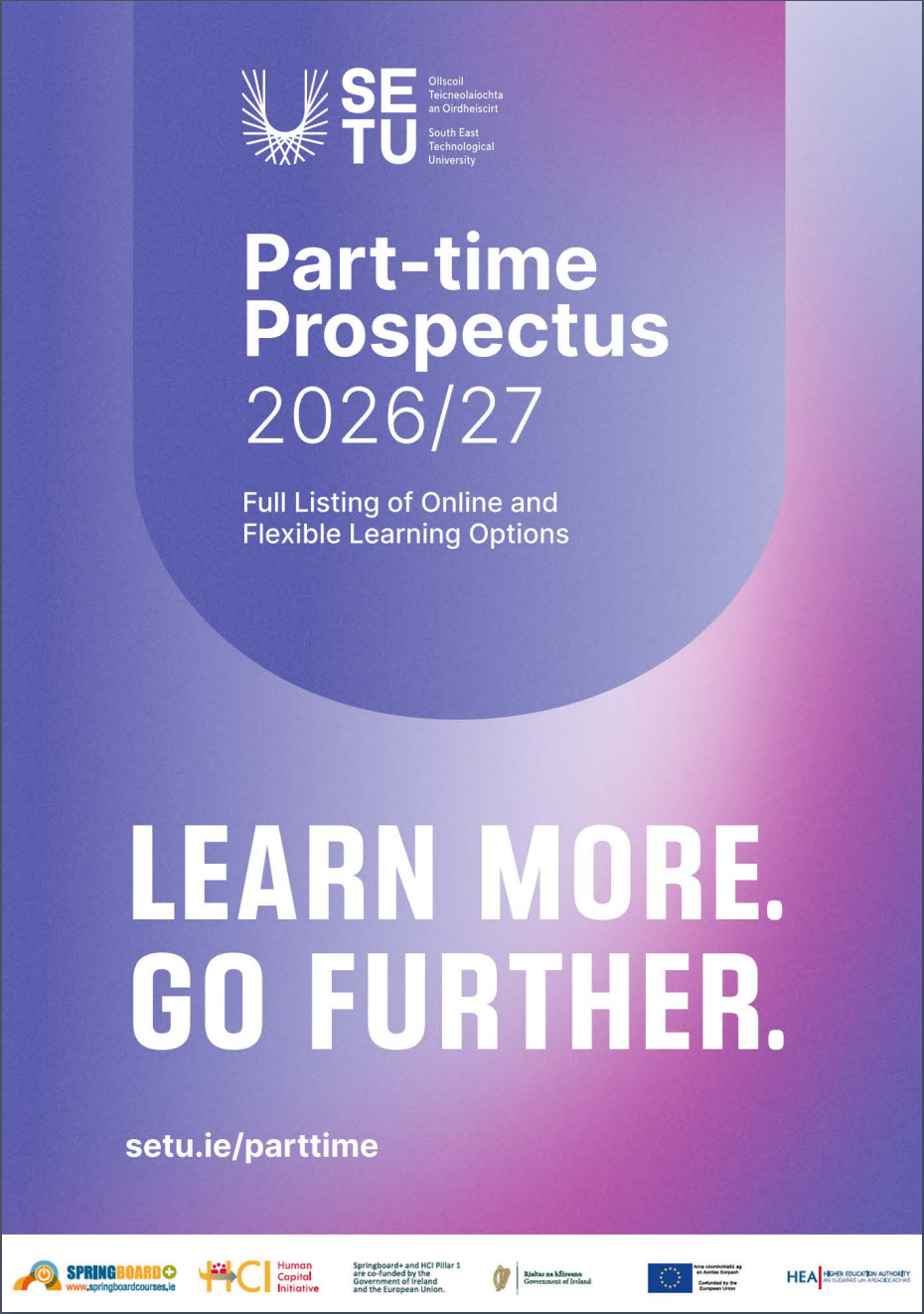


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and the European Union.



HEA
Higher Education Authority
Aitheasc na hOllscoirí

Publications



Brochure



Course Flyer





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Nieuw-Nederlands
an Oostvaarders
South-East
Technological
University

**LEARN MORE.
GO FURTHER.**

**Changing career direction
requires confidence
and trusted guidance.**

Whether a learner,
professional, employer or
organisation, this line speaks
to how SETU LL opens doors
and creates opportunities for
people, businesses and
funders alike. It aligns
strongly with the desired
tone of voice in that it is
confidence-building, clear,
encouraging and supportive.

Apply today at
setu.ie/parttime

...son Porter, director at
ilevins Franks, said: "For
those that have already
moved their government
defined benefit [DB] scheme
to a Qrop prior to Sept 7, the
normal rules around Qrops
and how you can take the
pension benefits will apply.
"This is also dependent
upon the jurisdiction of the
Qrop, and the jurisdiction
where the policyholder is tax

"In theory, under EU law you are allowed freedom of transfer of pensions across EU member states, so it appears to contravene EU law."

The numbers involved are significant, and could result in billions of pounds being lost to the Treasury if a number of people had decided they wanted to

"Expats should not delay in exploring the options available to them. It is also more important than ever to retain specialist financial advice. It is not enough to assume that a particular course of action may or may not be possible or prudent."

Some people did manage to take advantage of the loophole to move their scheme before it was closed. Their transfer is complete they will consider whether...

Some people did manage to take advantage of the loophole to move their scheme before it was closed. Once their transfer is complete they will need to consider what to do with their pension next.

James McLeod, head of pensions at AES International, said: "Those people lucky enough to have squeezed through HMRC's ultimate cut off point on September 7 will now have almost complete control over their pensions, for the first time."

"The list of investments permitted under the Rops [the new name for Qrops] legislation is very similar to that offered under the UK's Sipp rules and so is very wide indeed.

"Investors will be able to build an investment portfolio which should allow them to continue to grow their capital, while also taking an income - although this of course depends very much on the size of the pot to begin with. The major

Justice of
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erwise
up
law,
pay the pensions of those
who have already retired
from those professions
tomorrow. So allowing a
fund transfer would mean
the Government coming up
with the cash.
Justin Harris, managing
director of Chase Belgrave,
said: "The lesson from this
episode should be that the
pensions environment in
the UK is highly fluid. Just as
the removal of the bulk of
the Australian Qrops
showed, possibilities can and
do change.
"Expats should
in exploring
avail

"Expats should not delay in exploring the options available to them. It is also more important than ever to retain specialist financial advice. It is not enough to assume that a particular course of action may or may not be possible or prudent," says one of the people who did manage to secure an advantageous exit route.

"On a positive note, it is already common to see contractual arrangements in place between UK financial advisers and Qrop specialists."

"The same kind of firms will simply extend their relationships to include the other required parties."

“From the client’s perspective, this is unlikely to be favourable. An unwieldy arrangement anyway, it is always easier to make on board and understand advice where it is concurrently from one to another. Receiving four different bits of information from four different parties is not a good idea.”

"Receiving four or five different but connected documents, and having to pull them all together to understand the overall position, is difficult for anybody to do."

Thanks to...

compli...

Thanks to the increasingly complicated nature of UK pension transfers overseas, this is certainly not something that you should undertake without first seeking some advice on the subject from an expert.

Earning at SETU Design Toolkit 37

In the worst case scenario, this would mean potentially five different firms or advisers involved in providing advice and charging fees for that advice, on a pension scheme which may only be worth just in excess of £30,000.

"On a positive note, it is already common to see contractual arrangements in place between UK financial advisers and Qrop specialists."

"The same kind of firms will simply extend their relationships to include the other required parties."

"From the client's perspective, this is to be favored," says the UK advisers and specialists.

“From the client’s perspective, this is unlikely to be favourable. An unwieldy arrangement anyway, it is always easier to take on board and understand advice where it is given concurrently from one point to another.”

"Receiving four or five different but connected documents, and having to pull them all together to understand the overall position, is difficult for anybody to do."

Thanks to...

compli...

Thanks to the increasingly complicated nature of UK pension transfers overseas, this is certainly not something that you should undertake without first seeking some advice on the subject from an expert.

Searching for

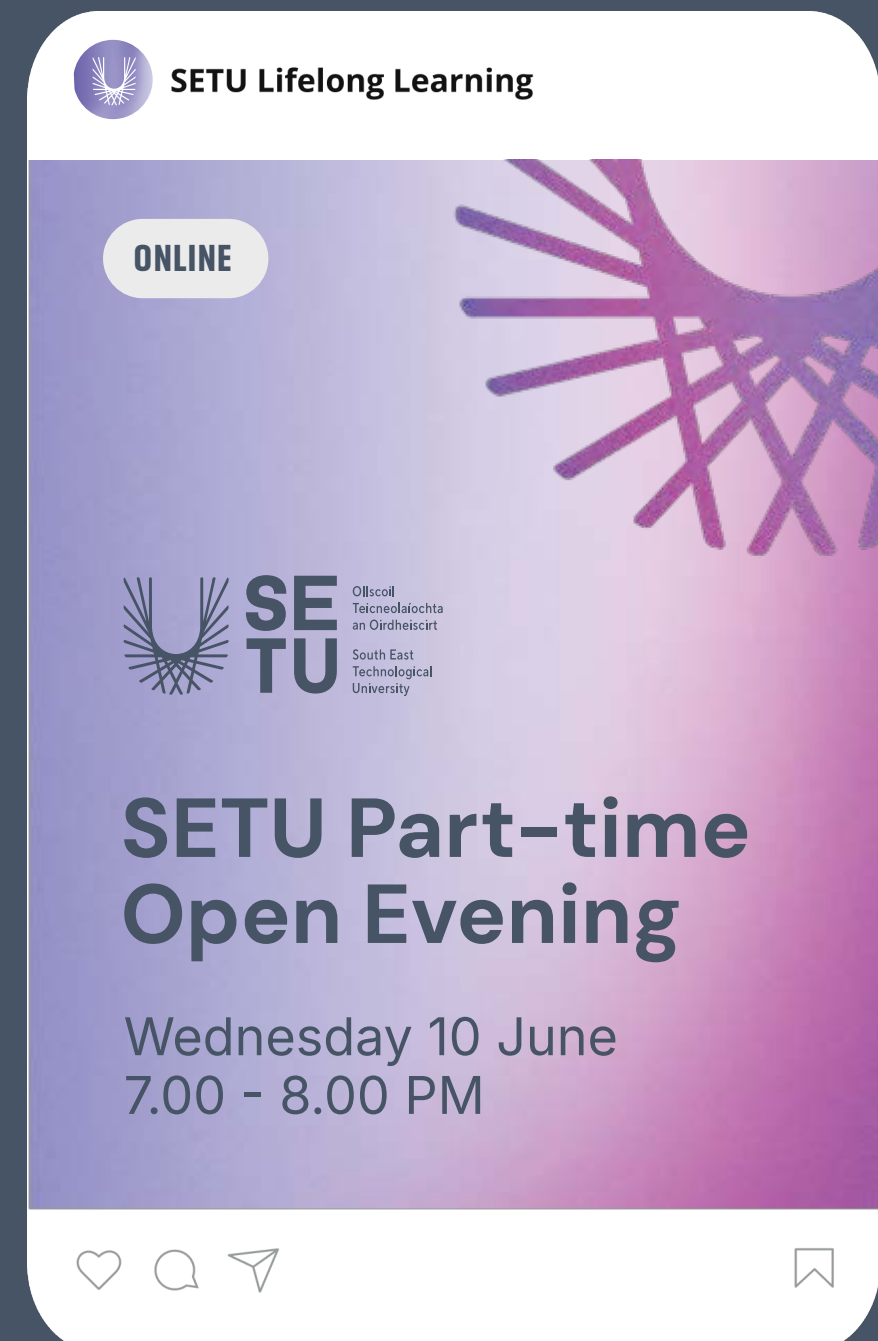
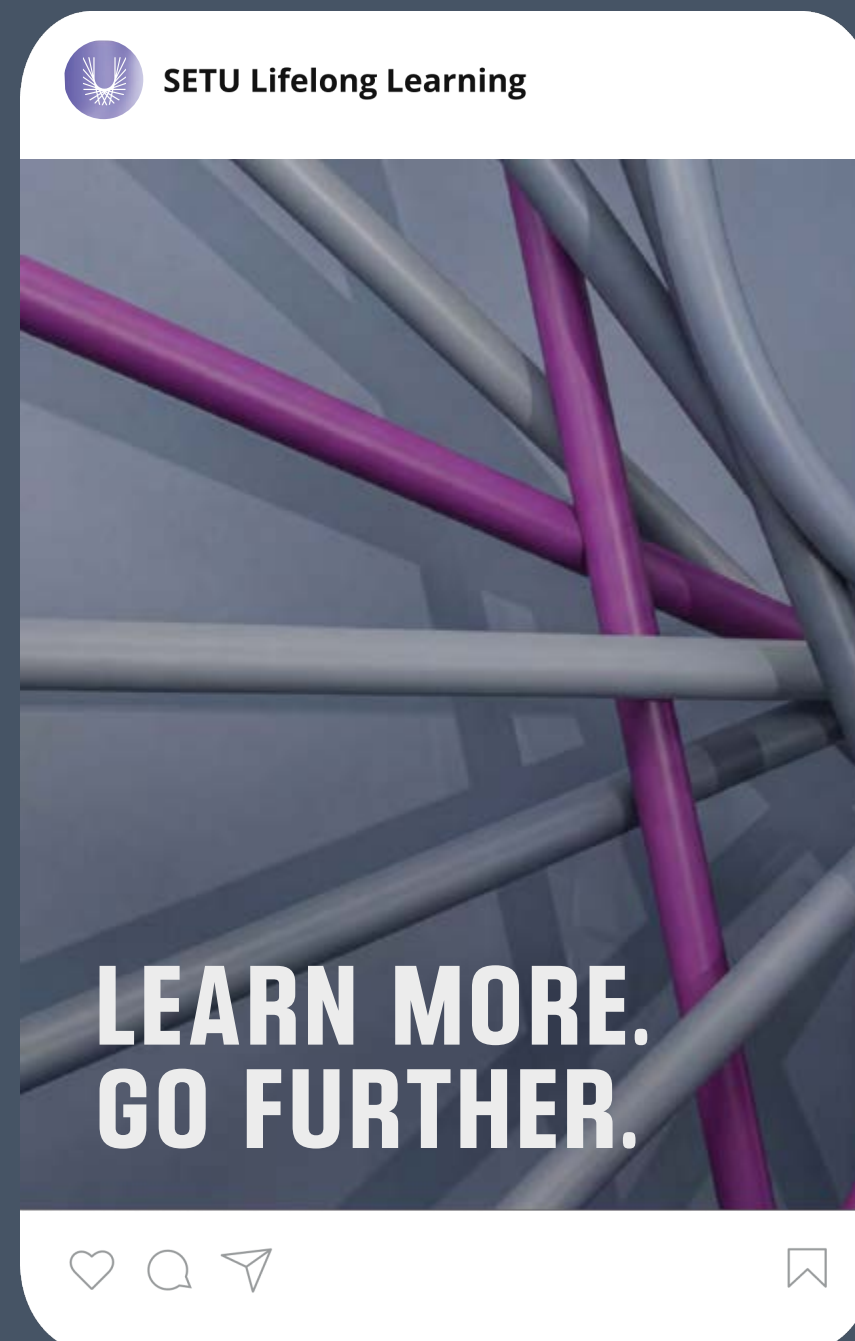
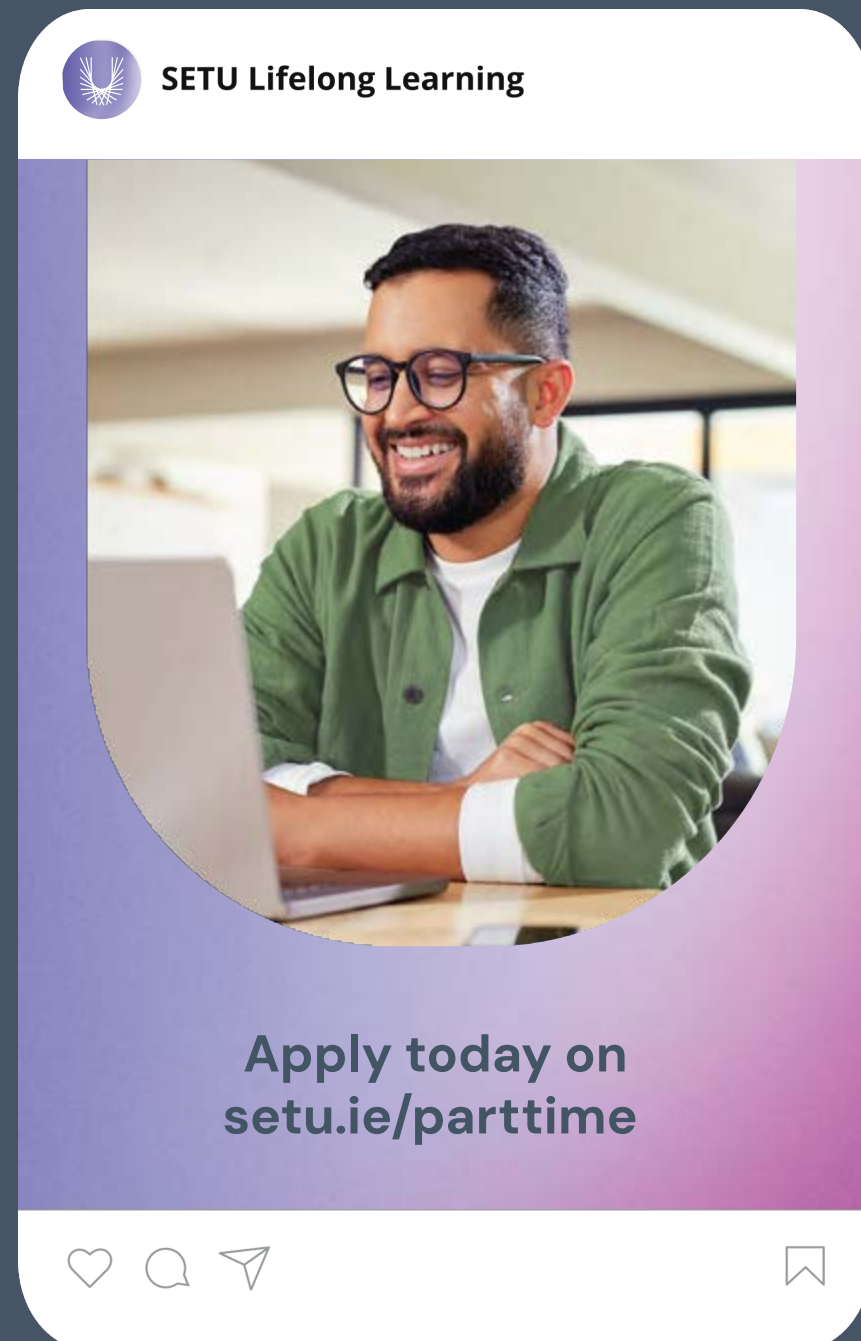
EXPATS looking to move to a retirement village in the UK can look online at a range of properties on sale through Retirement Homesearch. It's been selling retirement homes in the UK for 30 years and last year sold 1,800 units. Managing director Freeth said:

Freeth said that Retirement Homesearch sells retirement properties for a variety of developers and also acts in conjunction with 900 independent estate agents. He says that as a company looking to

Pull-Up Banner



Social Media



Social Media (continued)





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Thinking about your next step?

Whether you're looking to upskill, change direction or build on existing experience, Lifelong Learning at SETU offers flexible pathways designed to fit around work and life.

setu.ie/parttime



Powerpoint

Presentation Title
Presentation Title
DM Sans Bold 42pt
Subtitle/ Name Surname Inter Medium 18pt



Pic to be
editable



setu.ie



Presentation Title
Presentation Title
DM Sans Bold 38pt
Subtitle/ Name Surname
Inter Medium 18pt



Pic to be
editable

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Presentation Title
Presentation Title
DM Sans Bold 38pt
Subtitle/ Name Surname
Inter Medium 18pt



Pic to be
editable

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Slide Title
DM Sans Bold
40pt

**“Quote goes
here or large
statement goes
here DM Sans
Bold 44pt.”**

setu.ie | 3

Slide Title
DM Sans Bold
40pt

DM Sans Bold 25pt Sub heading
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- Body Inter medium 25pt
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- Body Inter medium 25pt
- Body Inter medium 25pt



Pic to be
editable

**Big sentence,
Quote goes
here or large
statement goes
here DM Sans
Bold 44pt.**

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Contact details
DM Sans Bold 21pt

Inter Medium 21pt
Ut dolor alitintis evenis
aliqui dias alic tem est
Ut dolor alitintis evenis
aliqui dias alic tem est



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Tote Bag



If you have any questions on the
Lifelong Learning at SETU visual
language , please contact:

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Brand Manager
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